Superseding
MIL-C-81331(AS)
21 October 1965

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, IMPULSE, MARK 73 MOD 0

This specification has been approved by the Naval Air Systems Command, Department of the Navy.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This document governs the manufacture, assembly and preparation for delivery of the MARK 73 MOD 0 impulse cartridge and the methods of inspection and tests upon which product acceptance will be based.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications, standards, drawings and publications, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Military

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of
MIL-D-21625	Design and Evaluation of Cartridges for Cartridge Actuated Devices
MIL-P-46610	Primers, Percussion, Styphnate and Chlorate Types, for Small Arms Ammunition

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

FSC 1377

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MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-414	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Variables

DRAWINGS AND ASSOCIATED LISTS

Naval Air Systems Command	(Code Ident No. 30003)
DL 2518226	Cartridge, Impulse, MARK 73 MOD 0
2518208	Container, Inner, Assembly
2518209	Cartridge, Impulse, MARK 73 MOD 0, Packaging Assembly
2518226	Cartridge, Impulse, MARK 73 MOD 0, Assembly
2518228	Head Assembly
U. S. Army Munitions Command	(Code Ident No. 19200)
C-7645339	Primer, Percussion

PUBLICATIONS

Bureau of Naval Weapons	
OP 5	Ammunition Ashore (This publication is not furnished to the bidders and contractors by the procuring activity. Contractors should contact the Government Inspector for use of the publication.
WR-43	Preparation of Quality Assurance Provisions

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the Contracting Officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS

49 CFR 171-178	Department of Transportation, Explosives and Other Dangerous Articles

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402. Orders for the above publication should request the latest edition and supplements thereto.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General.

3.1.1 The MARK 73 MOD 0 impulse cartridge covered by this specification shall be manufactured in accordance with DL 2518226 and all documents listed thereon.

3.2 Materials. All materials used in the manufacture of the cartridges shall conform strictly with the specifications referenced on the respective NAVAIR drawings unless specific approval in writing covering a departure therefrom has been obtained from the cognizant Navy field activity prior to manufacture. When alternate materials or methods of cartridge manufacture are specified on the drawings, the bidder's selections shall be clearly stated in the proposal.

3.2.1 Preproduction sample. Unless otherwise specified by the procuring activity, a preproduction sample of 70 cartridges shall be manufactured using the same methods and procedures proposed for the production lot. The sample shall be tested as specified in 4.3.2 and is for the purpose of determining that the contractor, prior to starting production, is capable of producing items which comply with the technical requirements of the contract.

3.3 Primary components. For the purposes of this specification the primer and the main charge propellant are defined as primary components. See 4.3.3.

3.4 Primer. The primers shall be furnished from lots manufactured within the preceding twelve months. The primers shall be 50M loaded with Remington Arms Primer Mixture 5061W, manufactured in accordance with Drawing C-7645339 and shall be from lots which were accepted in accordance with MIL-P-46610, Class 1. See 4.7.1.

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3.4.1 X-ray. Primers shall be free of the following defects when examined by X-ray in accordance with 4.7.2: missing or abnormally thin charge; charge broken, cracked or porous; cracked or off-center anvil or other misplaced or deformed inert parts; anvil abnormally close to primer cup dome; and all other observable defects in assembly.

3.5 Propellant charge.

3.5.1 Quantity. All main propellant charges and booster charges shall be as specified on Drawings 2518226 and 2518228, respectively. Charges shall be determined by weight rather than by volume measurements.

3.5.2 Smokeless powder, handling and loading. Do not subject the smokeless powder to unnecessary handling or exposure to the atmosphere. The handling and loading of smokeless powder exposed to the atmosphere shall be performed only under conditions that do not permit the relative humidity to exceed 75 percent.

3.5.3 Smokeless powder, condition. The smokeless powder utilized shall exhibit no evidence of decomposition. See 4.7.3.

3.6 Cartridge inspection.

3.6.1 Visual inspection. Cartridges shall be free of the following visible defects: dents, deep scratches, sharp edges, cracks, burrs, split or cracked lip in the crimped area, damaged closure disc, incomplete or improper sealant application, or any other imperfections which could prevent entry into the firing chamber, or adversely affect performance or resistance to moisture. See 4.7.4.

3.6.2 Leakage. Cartridge leakage rate shall not exceed 10^{-5} cc of air or gas per second when tested in accordance with 4.7.5.

3.6.3 X-ray. Cartridges shall be free of imperfections when examined by X-ray in accordance with 4.7.6.

3.7 Ballistic requirements. Cartridges from each production lot, selected in accordance with 4.7.7.1, shall meet the requirements listed below when subjected to the test prescribed in 4.7.7.1.

3.7.1 Pressure. The upper limit of maximum pressure shall be 14,500 pounds per square inch. See 4.7.7.1.1.1.

3.7.2 Velocity. The lower limit of velocity shall be 73 feet per second. See 4.7.7.1.1.2.

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3.7.3 Misfire. There shall be no misfires. See 4.7.7.1.1.3.

3.7.4 Hangfire. There shall be no hangfires. See 4.7.7.1.1.4.

3.8 Change in propellant lot. Whenever a change occurs in the propellant lot for the main charge, test firings shall be conducted in accordance with 4.7.9.

3.9 Packaging, Packing and Marking. The packaging and packing of cartridges and the container markings shall be in accordance with Section 5.

3.10 Workmanship. Cartridges shall be constructed and finished in a manner to assure compliance with all requirements of this specification. Particular attention should be directed to dimensions, finishes and coatings.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling. Unless otherwise specified, and when applicable, the sampling plans and procedures used in the determination of the acceptability of products submitted by a supplier shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-414 or MIL-STD-105, whichever applies.

4.3 Lots.

4.3.1 Inspection lots. Inspection lot definition, formation, and size shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-414 or MIL-STD-105, whichever applies.

4.3.2 Preproduction sample. Before entering into quantity production, an acceptable preproduction sample of 70 cartridges shall be prepared. Of these cartridges, 60 shall be expended in the tests listed below and 10 shall be retained for investigative purposes. A preproduction sample acceptable for environmental and functional

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testing shall be defined as a sample which has met the requirements of paragraphs 3.6.1 through 3.6.3 of this specification. Preproduction sample acceptance shall consist of the following tests as prescribed in Table 3 of MIL-D-21625: Leak test (60); 15 "g" shock (6); vibration (6); temperature and humidity cycling (12). Numbers in parentheses denote the number of cartridges allocated for test. These cartridges shall, after exposure to environmental treatment, be conditioned for a minimum of six hours at +70°F ± 5°F together with 12 untreated cartridges and fired in the test fixture of 4.7.7.1. In addition, 24 cartridges shall be temperature conditioned for a minimum of six hours (12 at -65°F ± $^{0}_{5}$°F and 12 at +160°F ± $^{5}_{0}$°F) and fired in the test fixture of 4.7.7.1. All cartridges shall fire and produce results within the limits set forth in 3.7. The failure of any cartridge to meet the acceptance requirements as stated above shall cause rejection of the preproduction sample. Any quantity production prior to notification by the contracting agency of preproduction sample acceptability shall be at the contractor's risk.

4.3.3 Production lot. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the minimum and maximum production lot size shall be 181 and 800 cartridges, respectively. Only primary components from a single lot shall be used in a production lot of cartridges; however, one primary component production lot may be used in more than one cartridge production lot.

4.4 Gages. The contractor shall provide gages as necessary to insure that the material to which this specification applies will meet the dimensional requirements shown on the applicable drawings.

4.5 Classification of characteristics. The characteristics verified by the tests and examinations herein are classified as Critical, Major and Minor in accordance with WR-43. Tests and examinations that verify critical characteristics are identified by the symbol (C) and major characteristics by the symbol (M). The number following the classification symbol indicates the serial number of test or examination. Tests and examinations which are not annotated with a classification code are classified minor.

4.6 Quality conformance. Quality conformance inspection shall consist of verification of the characteristics classified on the drawings of DL 2518226, and verification of the following requirements and tests:

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Item	Nature of Requirement Verification	Applicable Paragraphs	Classification (WR-43)
Primary component	Single lot verification	3.3, 4.3.3	(M101)
Primer	Age, loading and acceptance	3.4, 4.7.1	(C1)
Primer	X-ray	3.4.1, 4.7.2	(C2)
Propellant	Type and weight	3.5.1	(C3)
Smokeless powder	Condition	3.5.3, 4.7.3	(C4)
Cartridge	Visual inspection	3.6.1, 4.7.4	(M102)
Cartridge	Leakage	3.6.2, 4.7.5	(C5)
Cartridge	X-ray	3.6.3, 4.7.6	(C6)
Cartridge	Ballistic test	3.7, 4.7.7	(C7)
Cartridge	Ballistic (change in propellant lot)	3.8, 4.7.9	(C8)
Cartridge	Packaging, packing and container markings	3.9, 4.6.1	(M103)

4.6.1 Packaging, packing and marking. Quality conformance inspection shall be conducted in accordance with the inspection criteria on the applicable drawings referenced in Section 5.

4.7 Tests.

4.7.1 Primer, verification. Verification shall be provided that the primers to be used were manufactured, loaded and accepted in accordance with the requirements of 3.4, and are from lots manufactured within the preceding 12 months.

4.7.2 Primer X-ray. Examine all primers by X-ray and reject those having any of the defects of 3.4.1. For the most revealing exposure the primers are laid on their side with the anvil cutouts vertical. Pressure sensitive tape may be used as an aid in positioning the primers.

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4.7.3 Smokeless powder, condition. Smokeless powder shall be inspected in accordance with the applicable paragraphs of OP 5. Evidence of decomposition shall be cause for rejection.

4.7.4 Visual inspection. Examine all completely assembled cartridges and reject those having any of the defects noted in 3.6.1.

4.7.5 Leakage. Each cartridge in the preproduction sample or ballistic sample shall be leak tested in a dry gas or dry air leak tester. Cartridges which exhibit a leak rate in excess of 10^{-5} cc/sec air or gas at a pressure differential of one atmosphere shall be considered defective. Cartridges of the preproduction sample which exhibit a leakage defect shall be rejected. If one or more cartridges of the production lot sample exhibit a leakage defect, than a 100% leak test of the lot being tested shall be required at no additional expense to the Government. Cartridges which exhibit a leak rate in excess of that specified above shall be rejected.

4.7.6 X-ray examination. Examine all cartridges by X-ray and reject those having any imperfections. The cartridges shall be positioned on their sides for the most revealing exposure.

4.7.7 Ballistic tests.

4.7.7.1 The number of cartridges selected from each production lot for the ballistic tests shall be in accordance with the requirements of Tables A-2 and B-1 of MIL-STD-414 Inspection Level IV and an AQL of 0.04. The cartridges shall be conditioned for a minimum of six hours at +70°F ± 5°F and fired in the test set shown in Figures 1 and 2. Air pressure of 1000 ± 50 psi shall be used to actuate the firing mechanism. This test set consists of a 235 pound weight mounted on a tube. Upon firing the cartridge, the weight is propelled at an angle of 75 degrees with the horizontal. The internal configuration and dimensions are shown in Figure 2. In addition to the sample of cartridges for the above test, 10 additonal cartridges shall be furnished from the production lot for investigative purposes.

4.7.7.1.1 Criteria of acceptance.

4.7.7.1.1.1 Pressure. The upper specification limit (U) for maximum pressure shall be as specified in 3.7.1. Instrumentation used shall record the maximum chamber pressure to within an accuracy of 2.0 percent. Lot acceptability shall be determined in accordance with the applicable provisions of MIL-STD-414 at an AQL of 0.04.

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4.7.7.1.1.2 Velocity. The velocity of the propelled weight shall be measured over an interval of 3.00 ± 0.06 inches commencing 21.5 ± 0.5 inches from the initial position of the weight. Instrumentation used shall record the ejection velocity to within an accuracy of 2.0 percent. The lower specification limit (L) shall be as specified in 3.7.2. Lot acceptability shall be determined in accordance with the applicable provisions of MIL-STD-414 at an AQL of 0.04.

4.7.7.1.1.3 Misfire. The failure of any cartridge to fire shall result in rejection of the lot represented, unless such failure is plainly attributable to faulty test equipment or procedure.

4.7.7.1.1.4 Hangfire. One or more hangfires shall result in rejection of the lot represented. A hangfire is defined as a firing in which the elapsed time between actuation of the firing mechanism and start of pressure rise exceeds 0.050 seconds.

4.7.8 Retest. There shall be no retests.

4.7.8.1 Test failure. If test failure is attributable to an assignable cause, excluding the test cartridges, original test results should be discarded and that part of the test reconducted.

4.7.9 Change in propellant lot. Whenever a change in propellant lot for the main charge occurs, validity of the charge determination shall be verified by firing 36 cartridges which have been temperature conditioned for a minimum of six hours (12 at -65°F ± $^{0}_{5}$°F, 12 at +70°F ± 5°F and 12 at +160°F ± $^{5}_{0}$°F). Results of these firings shall fall within the limits prescribed in 3.7.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging. For definitions of packaging levels, see 6.4.

5.1.1 Level A. Level A packaging shall be used for packaging of all production lots for service use. One cartridge shall be packaged in an inner container in accordance with Drawing 2518208.

5.1.2 Level B. Not applicable.

5.1.3 Level C. When directed by the procuring activity, those cartridges which are intended for expenditure in preproduction sample testing and for production lot acceptance tests shall be packaged in accordance with Method III of MIL-P-116 and with the Code of Federal Regulations 49 CFR 171-178.

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5.2 Packing. For definitions of packing levels, see 6.4.

5.2.1 Level A. Level A packing shall be used for packing of all production lots for service use. Six inner containers as described in 5.1.1 shall be packed in accordance with Drawing 2518209.

5.2.2 Level B. Not applicable.

5.2.3 Level C. When directed by the procuring activity, cartridges intended for expenditure in preproduction sample testing and for production lot acceptance tests and are packaged in accordance with 5.1.3 shall be packed to afford protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use. Shipping containers shall be in accordance with the Code of Federal Regulations 49 CFR 171-178.

5.3 Markings.

5.3.1 Special markings. Marking of exterior containers shall be in accordance with the Code of Federal Regulations 49 CFR 171-178.

5.3.2 Normal markings. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the marking information on unit packages and shipping containers shall be as specified on Drawings 2518208 and 2518209, respectively. The specified marking information shall be applied to the containers in accordance with the applicable provisions of MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. This cartridge was originally designed for use in the canopy jettison cylinder for the A-6A aircraft.

6.2 Ordering information. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. title, number and date of this specification;

b. whether preproduction inspection is required and if so, specify the test activity;

c. production lot size and test activity (see 4.3.3);

d. items of data required for each preproduction and production lot (see 6.3).

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6.3 Data. For the information of contractors and contracting officers, any of the data specified in (a) subparagraphs below, (b) applicable documents listed in Section 2 of this specification or (c) referenced lower-tier documents need not be prepared for the Government and shall not be furnished to the Government unless specified in the contract or order.

6.3.1 Test report. Results of ballistic tests shall be forwarded to the Naval Air Systems Command (AIR-53222) and the procuring activity.

6.3.2 Data cards. The contract or order should state the format, quantity and destination of data cards.

6.4 Definitions. For the purpose of this specification the following definitions apply.

6.4.1 Level A packaging. The degree of preservation and packaging which will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration and physical damage during handling, shipment, indeterminate storage and world-wide redistribution.

6.4.1.1 Level C packaging. The degree of preservation and packaging which will afford adequate protection against corrosion, deterioration and physical damage during shipment from supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use. This level may conform to supplier's commercial practice when such meets the requirements of this level.

6.4.2 Level A packing. The degree of packing which will afford adequate protection during shipment, handling, indeterminate storage and world-wide redistribution.

6.4.2.1 Level C packing. The degree of packing which will afford protection against damage during direct domestic shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use. This level in general will conform to applicable carrier rules and regulations and may be the supplier's commercial practice when such meets the requirement of this level.

6.5 Explosives safety precautions. Safety precautions for explosive-loaded items are contained in MIL-STD-1314.

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6.5.1 Applicability. The loading, assembly and handling of the explosives, explosive-loaded subassemblies and the finished items covered by this specification involve hazardous operations and therefore require suitable explosives safety precautions. At plants of the Naval Air Systems Command, Department of the Navy, and other Government plants where the Government is responsible for safety, the precautions listed in MIL-STD-1314 are mandatory. These same minimum provisions are recommended for observance by a contractor or manufacturer that explosively loads or assembles the item covered in this specification in order to fulfill his own safety responsibility.

Project No. 1377-N409

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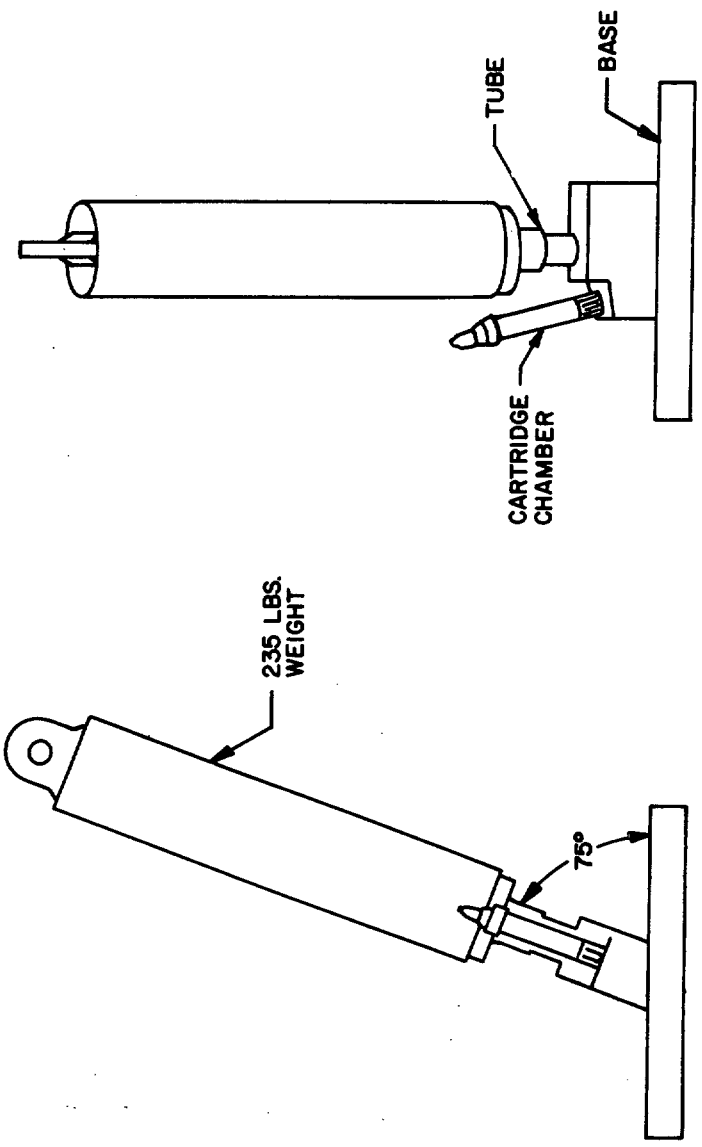


FIGURE 1: TEST SET FOR MARK 73 MOD 0 IMPULSE CARTRIDGE

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NOTES:

1. ALL DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES.
2. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED: TOLERANCES ARE WITHIN .005.

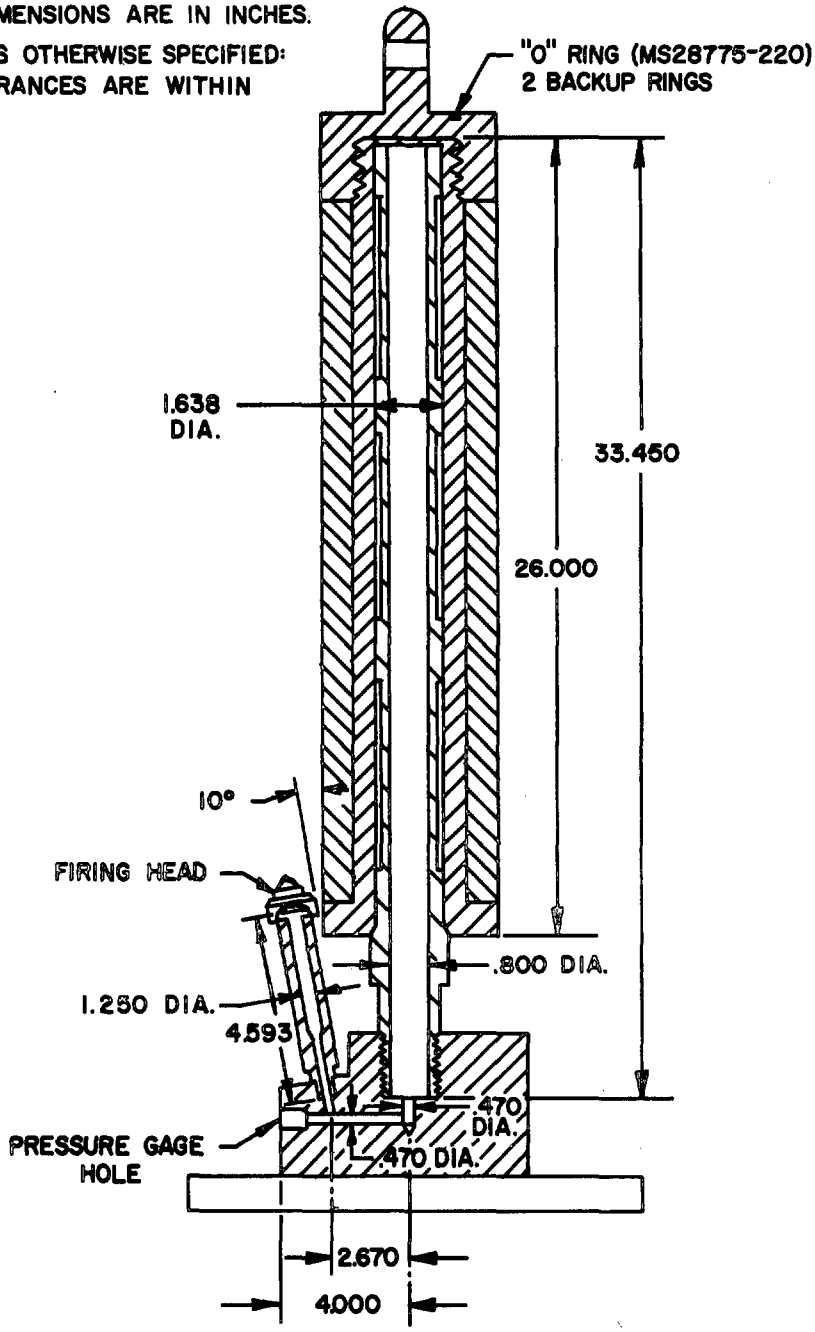


FIGURE 2: INTERNAL CONFIGURATION OF TEST SET FOR MARK 73 MOD 0 IMPULSE CARTRIDGE

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity *(as indicated on reverse hereof)*.

SPECIFICATION
MIL-C-81331A(AS) CARTRIDGE, IMPULSE, MARK 73 MOD 0

ORGANIZATION *(Of submitter)*	CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.	QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED	DOLLAR AMOUNT
		$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*	DATE

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DEPARTMENT OF THE NAVY
Naval Air Systems Command
Washington, D.C. 20360

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